MODULE-2 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

2.2 Tour Pre Roll

Lesson masterclass · implementation drills · war-room directive

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Use tour dates as story, deadline, and market at once.
- Manufacture airplay demand before you ever arrive.
- Convert the show’s aftermath into proof inside 48 hours.

★ **INSIDER RADIO TIP**

The show’s aftermath is the real asset. Send a 20-second vertical crowd clip on the night itself; the next-day ‘we’re still talking about it’ email is the strongest thank-you in the economy.

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2.2 Tour Pre-Roll — Manufacture Airplay Demand With Dates

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THE ONE-LINE TRUTH: A confirmed show date is the single most potent airplay catalyst in independent music — converting an abstract song submission into a time-stamped, ticket-selling community event.

MASTERCLASS DIRECTIVE & STRATEGIC BLUEPRINT

Strategic Foundation & Operational Reality

The most difficult hurdle in radio promotion is overcoming programmer inertia. A music director listens to dozens of excellent songs every week. Even when they appreciate your sound, they frequently defer action: “Great track, let’s keep an ear on them for next quarter.”

A confirmed live concert date completely shatters this inertia by introducing a hard **countdown clock**.

When you pitch a station with an upcoming tour date in their market, the entire commercial dynamic flips:

- You are no longer asking them to evaluate your song in an academic vacuum.
- You are offering their listeners an immediate real-world entertainment experience.
- You provide an urgent news hook: the station can conduct an on-air interview, give away ticket pairs to listeners, and brand themselves as the cultural patron behind a vibrant live event.

This methodology is known as **Tour Pre-Roll**. It synchronizes radio outreach with live performance routing on a disciplined, backwards-engineered countdown starting exactly 21 days prior to venue load-in.

The 21-Day Tour Pre-Roll Timeline

To extract maximum airplay and ticket conversion, execute this strict 4-phase chronological sequence:

- **T-21 Days (The Anchor Pitch):** Deliver your high-value 90-word pitch to the Music Director and specialty show hosts. Lead with the venue name, performance date, and ticket link. Offer a 10-minute in-studio or phone interview during afternoon drive on the day of show, plus two pairs of guest-list tickets for station listeners.
- **T-14 Days (The Asset Follow-Up):** If unconfirmed, deliver a 30-second live acoustic performance clip or a dynamic 20-second crowd video demonstrating real-world audience energy. Remind the programmer of the upcoming local date.
- **T-7 Days (The Ticket / Station ID Drop):** Provide pre-recorded custom station audio sweepers ("Hey, this is [Artist Name], catch us live this Friday at [Venue], spinning now on [Station Callsign]"). Secure on-air spin placement during the pre-weekend specialty show.
- **T+2 Days (The Post-Show Crowd Telegram):** Within 48 hours of load-out, email the programmer a high-resolution 15-second crowd video of the audience singing your chorus, thanking the station for supporting local live music. This single gesture cements a lifetime relationship and guarantees immediate adds on your next single.

IMPLEMENTATION DRILLS & PASS STANDARDS

- **Drill 1 — The Tour-Date Airplay Sync (30 min).** Review your calendar for the next 90 days. Select three confirmed or planned dates. Populate the Tour Pre-Roll Calendar Worksheet below with specific T-21, T-14, and T-7 dates.
- **Drill 2 — The Station Ticket-Pack Architecture (15 min).** Draft a formal email template offering station ticket giveaways (2 pairs of guest-list passes) and an afternoon interview window during load-in.
- **Drill 3 — The Custom Station Sweeper Script (20 min).** Record a clean 15-second station audio drop on your phone or studio microphone: "Hey this is [Artist], live at [Venue] on [Date], and you're locked into [Station]".
- **Drill 4 — The Post-Show Telegram Protocol (10 min).** Create a reminder in your phone calendar for Show Night + 24 hours: 'Record crowd clip and dispatch thank-you telegram to station programmer.'

ACTION WORKSHEET & OPERATIONAL PROTOCOL

Protocol Document: `TOUR PRE-ROLL CAMPAIGN SCHEDULER`

Complete the structured table below as part of your lesson implementation. This worksheet directly replaces legacy spreadsheets with a publication-grade execution protocol.

Tour City & Venue	Show Date	Target Station & MD	T-21 Anchor Pitch Date	T-14 Asset Drop Date	T-7 Ticket / Sweeper Date
Milwaukee, WI (Cactus Club)	October 14	WMSE 91.7 FM (MD: Tom)	September 23	September 30	October 7
Madison, WI (High Noon Saloon)	October 15	WSUM 91.7 FM (MD: Sarah)	September 24	October 1	October 8
Minneapolis, MN (7th St Entry)	October 17	Radio K 100.7 (MD: Chris)	September 26	October 3	October 10
Detroit, MI (Magic Stick)	November 4	WJLB / WDET (MD: Marcus)	October 14	October 21	October 28
Cleveland, OH (Grog Shop)	November 6	WCSB 89.3 FM (MD: Elena)	October 16	October 23	October 30

WAR-ROOM NOTES

WAR-ROOM DIRECTIVE — 2.2 Tour Pre-Roll — Manufacture Airplay Demand With Dates

HOW TO RUN TOUR PRE-ROLL WITH ZERO EXISTING TOUR DATES

If you do not currently have an active tour booked, you do not wait. You **manufacture a regional micro-run**. Book two weekend dates within 90 miles of home (e.g., Friday night in your hometown club, Saturday night at a neighboring college town bar).

Even a single two-venue weekend run provides the legitimate, time-stamped news hook required to execute the Tour Pre-Roll sequence.

THE INTERVIEW TIME-WINDOW STRATEGY:

When offering an interview to a radio programmer, never ask them to accommodate your schedule. Propose a specific, convenient window that aligns with their broadcast clock:

- “I will be arriving at [Venue] for soundcheck at 4:30 PM. I can drop by your studio between 2:00 PM and 3:30 PM for a 10-minute live chat and acoustic performance, or patch in via phone at your exact convenience.”

This signals extreme professional consideration and eliminates scheduling friction.

FREQUENCY DOMINION COMMUNITY DRILLS

1. Post your upcoming tour dates and matching radio station targets from your Pre-Roll Scheduler.
2. Share the exact script you will record for your station-specific audio sweeper drop.
3. Discuss how you plan to capture the 15-second Post-Show Crowd Telegram video during your next gig.
4. If you currently have no dates booked, announce your 14-day deadline to book a regional two-date micro-run.

Key Takeaways

REMEMBER THIS

- Dates are story, deadline, and market in one.
- The show’s aftermath is the real asset.
- A night-of clip converts at show + 48 hours.

Self-Assessment · Check Your Mastery

PASS BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- 1. Are my tour dates confirmed and mapped to stations?
- 2. Did I plan a night-of crowd clip for each market?
- 3. Is my ‘still talking about it’ next-day email drafted?